# Skippy for Linux User Guide

Install and use Skippy on a Linux desktop - version 1.19.2

Skippy is group video calling for up to 10 people: audio, video, chat, file transfer and direct calls. The Linux app is the same desktop app as on Windows. Like every Skippy app it connects to a Skippy server run by someone in your group, so you need that server's address and an account on it.

> **This is a test release.** The Linux builds start and run on GitHub's test machines, but they have not been used in a real call on a real desktop yet. If something doesn't work, please report it - see **Reporting a problem** at the end.

## What you need

- A 64-bit Linux desktop with a recent distribution (Ubuntu 22.04 / Debian 12 / Fedora 38 or newer). **x86-64** PCs and **arm64** machines (for example a Raspberry Pi 4 or 5 running 64-bit Linux) are both supported.
- The **server address** from whoever runs your Skippy server, e.g. **100.64.0.10:8470**. If it starts with **100.** it is a Tailscale address: install Tailscale (tailscale.com/download), sign in to the server's account and run **tailscale up**.
- One file from the **latest release** at github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases: the **.AppImage** (works on any distribution) or the **.deb** (Debian, Ubuntu, Mint, Raspberry Pi OS) for your processor (**x86_64/amd64** for ordinary PCs, **arm64** for ARM).

## Install - choose one

### *Option A: AppImage (any distribution)*

1. Download **Skippy-1.19.2-linux-x86_64.AppImage** (or **-arm64.AppImage**).
2. Make it runnable: right-click it, **Properties, Permissions, Allow executing file as program** - or in a terminal:

```
chmod +x Skippy-1.19.2-linux-x86_64.AppImage
./Skippy-1.19.2-linux-x86_64.AppImage
```

An AppImage doesn't install anything; keep it somewhere like **~/Applications**. To update, download the new file and delete the old one. If it won't start because of **FUSE**, install it (**sudo apt install libfuse2** on Ubuntu 22.04/Debian; **libfuse2t64** on Ubuntu 24.04), or run it with **--appimage-extract-and-run**.

### *Option B: .deb package (Debian / Ubuntu family)*

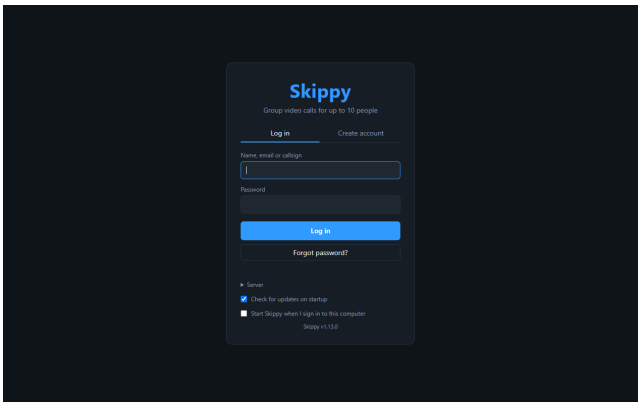
```
sudo apt install ./Skippy-1.19.2-linux-amd64.deb
```

(Use the **-arm64.deb** file on an ARM machine.) Skippy then appears in your applications menu, and **skippy** starts it from a terminal. Remove it with **sudo apt remove skippy**.

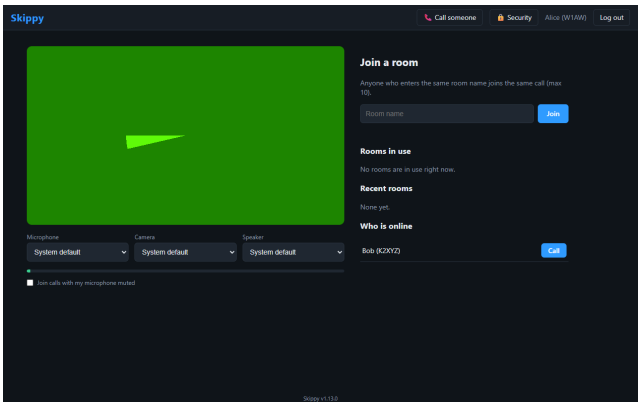
> **"The SUID sandbox helper binary was not configured correctly"** (or the AppImage closes at once on Ubuntu 23.10 / 24.04 and newer). Ubuntu now restricts the sandbox that Electron apps use. The .deb normally works as it is. For the AppImage, either run it with **--no-sandbox**, or allow it once with: **sudo sysctl -w kernel.apparmor_restrict_unprivileged_userns=0** (this lowers a system-wide protection, so prefer the .deb or **--no-sandbox** if you are unsure).

## First start

1. Start **Skippy**. On the login screen open **Server** and type the server address (**ws://** at the front is optional).
2. Create an account or log in; save the **recovery key** - it is the only way back in if you forget your password.
3. Allow camera and microphone if your desktop asks (Flatpak/Snap-style prompts only; a normal install uses them directly).




Login screen (Windows shown; the Linux window is identical).




The lobby: preview, devices, rooms and who is online.

## Linux specifics

| Topic | On Linux |
|---|---|
| Tray icon / closing the window | Skippy sits in the system tray; the window's close button **hides** it so calls can still come in. **GNOME hides tray icons by default**: install the *AppIndicator and KStatusNotifierItem Support* extension (Ubuntu has it built in) to see it. Without a tray you can always bring the window back by starting Skippy again, and quit it from the tray menu or with **Ctrl+Q**. |
| Start at login | Tray menu, **Start when I sign in to this computer**. Skippy then starts hidden. |
| Screen sharing | Click **Share**. On **X11** pick a screen or window in Skippy's list. On **Wayland** (the default on Ubuntu, Fedora) your desktop shows its own picker through **PipeWire**; this needs **xdg-desktop-portal** and the portal for your desktop (**xdg-desktop-portal-gnome** or **-kde**). If sharing fails, try starting Skippy with **--ozone-platform=x11**. |
| Camera / microphone / speaker | Pick them under **Devices**. A camera must be a normal V4L2 webcam (**/dev/video0**); you need to be allowed to use it (usually automatic on a desktop login). |
| Tailscale warning | If the server is on Tailscale and it is off, Skippy shows a banner; the button runs **tailscale up** (needs **tailscale set --operator=$USER** once if it asks for sudo). |
| Recording and transcripts | **Record** saves one audio track per speaker to **~/Documents/Skippy Recordings**. Transcripts need the **whisper.cpp** speech engine: build it (github.com/ggml-org/whisper.cpp) and put **whisper-cli** on your PATH or in **~/.local/bin**; then Skippy's transcript setup downloads the language model (about 190 MB) once. |

## Running the server on Linux

The server runs well on Linux (a small VPS, a Raspberry Pi, a home server). Install Node.js 22.13 or newer, download **Skippy-Server-<version>.zip** from the Releases page (the newest one that has it), unzip, and in that folder:

```
npm install
node server.js
```

It listens on port **8470** and keeps its data in **skippy.db** next to it. To keep it running, a systemd service works (example, untested - adjust the user and paths):

```
# /etc/systemd/system/skippy-server.service
[Unit]
Description=Skippy server
After=network-online.target
[Service]
User=skippy
WorkingDirectory=/opt/skippy-server
ExecStart=/usr/bin/node server.js
Restart=always
[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

## Troubleshooting

| Problem | What to try |
|---|---|
| **"Could not reach the server"** | Switch on Tailscale (if the address is 100.x), check address and port, and that the server is running. |
| AppImage does nothing or complains about FUSE / sandbox | See the install section: **libfuse2**, or **--appimage-extract-and-run**, or **--no-sandbox**. |
| No window after closing it | It is hidden in the tray. Start Skippy again, or use the tray menu. |
| Black video from my camera | Close other programs using the camera; check **v4l2-ctl --list-devices**; pick the camera under **Devices**. |
| Can't hear others | Check the output device under **Devices** and in your sound settings (PipeWire/PulseAudio). |
| Screen share is black or fails | On Wayland make sure the desktop portal is installed; or try **--ozone-platform=x11**. |
| Forgot my password | Use **Forgot password?** on the login screen with your recovery key. |

## Reporting a problem

Open an issue at **github.com/lrizio/Skippy/issues** and say:

- Skippy **version** (shown as "Skippy v..." on the login and lobby screens) and which file you used (AppImage or deb, x86_64 or arm64).
- Your **distribution and version**, desktop (GNOME, KDE...) and whether it is **Wayland or X11** (**echo $XDG_SESSION_TYPE**).
- What you did, what you expected and what happened. If Skippy won't start, run it from a terminal and paste the messages it prints.
- Please **don't** include passwords, recovery keys or a private server address.

Also useful: tell the author what *did* work, so it can be marked as verified.

Skippy for Linux shares its code with the Windows desktop app (v1.19.2); the desktop User Guide covers accounts, rooms and the server in more detail. Source and releases: github.com/lrizio/Skippy.